

July 2026: Both Q3 Headline Targets Crossed in Month One

All platforms: Instagram, Facebook, TikTok, LinkedIn, X and Threads. Numbers pulled directly from each platform's native analytics on August 4–5, 2026. Prepared by Reut.

[life is beta]

01 The Month's Bottom Line

July 1–31, 2026

8.24M

Views this month, all platforms

September target: 7M+ · crossed in month 1 of 3

~210K

Total followers across platforms

Target ~202K+ · crossed · +44K in one month

95.6K

Instagram followers — the raised 95K target is done

100K within reach · +24.4K in July

E97

International English podcast recorded & aired: Real Life Superpowers

Podcast KR — done in month 1

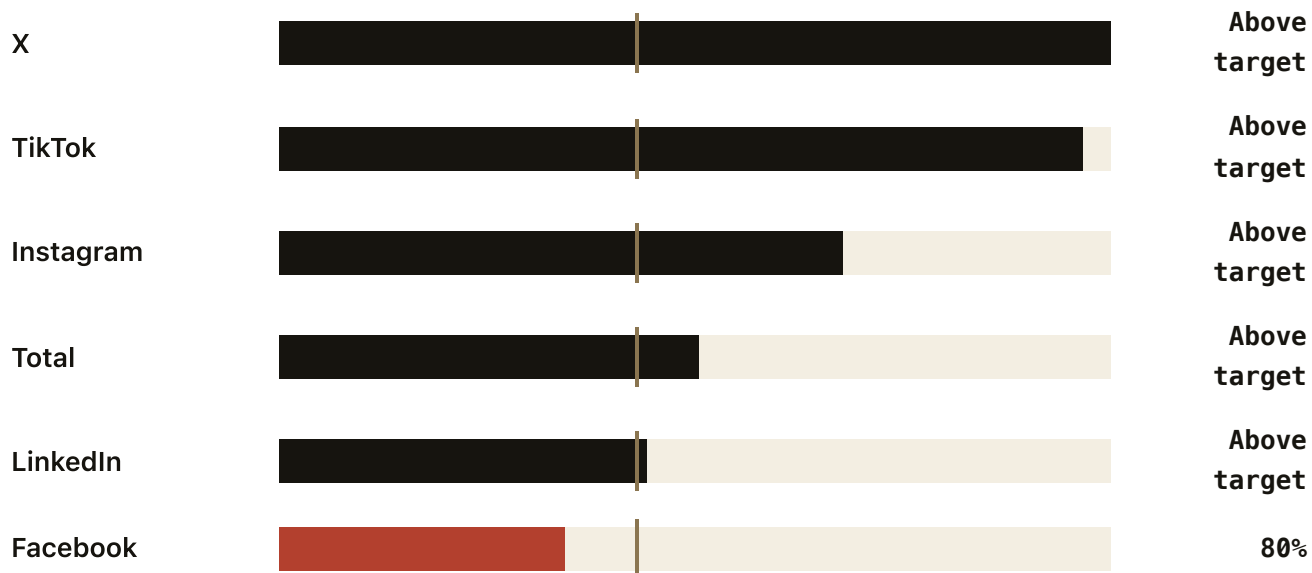
Done

Brand Book completed · Nasdaq Tower billboard live Jul 29

Website + dedicated shoot day next

02 July vs. the September Targets

Actual as % of the end-of-Q3 run-rate target



July views against each platform's September run-rate target. Gold line = the target. Four of five platforms are already past the September finish line with two months to spare; Facebook is at 80%.

KR	Target	Where it stands after month 1	Status
O1-KR1 · Reach	7M+ views/month and ~202K+ total followers by end of Q3 (floor: no month below 4.5M)	8.24M views · ~210K followers · the floor was nearly doubled	CROSSED IN MONTH 1
O1-KR2 · Podcast	1 international English appearance recorded by end of Q3	Real Life Superpowers E97 — 50-minute unscripted English interview, aired. Bonus: full transcript feeds the content system; \$20M+ ARR now publicly usable from Lior's own words. Next: Tier-1 pipeline — booking agency vetted (pricing inside)	DONE
O1-KR3 · Global Icon identity	Brand Book, website and strategy complete by end of Q3	Brand Book: completed. Remaining: website work + a dedicated photo-shoot day for it	ON TRACK

03 July at a Glance

Exact calendar month per platform

Platform	Views / Impressions	vs. June	Followers (Jul 31)	Net new	Verdict
Instagram	4,100,000	+56%	~95,300	+24,354	ABOVE TARGET
Facebook	3,181,303	-2.1%	85,191	+13,267	80% OF TARGET · ER 3.4%→8
TikTok	787,500	+149%	14,704	+2,000	ABOVE TARGET
X	93,400	+338%	487	~+170	ABOVE TARGET
LinkedIn	71,776	+38%	11,607	+821	ABOVE TARGET
Threads (mirror, zero effort)	5,719	—	2,891	—	FREE PRESENCE
Total	≈8,240,000	+35%	≈210,000	≈+44,000	BOTH TARGETS CROSSED

04

Platform Deep Dives

What the native analytics say

Instagram

DISCOVERY + CONVERSION ENGINE

TARGET DONE · 100K IN SIGHT

PERFORMANCE (IG MONTHLY RECAP, JUL 1–31)

Views

4.1M · +56% vs June

Views from non-followers

88%

Net new followers

+24,354 (5.2x June's pace)

Follower churn (share of new follows)

~8% – down from 91% in March, ~44% Apr–May, 26% in June

Interactions (30d)

~224K

Profile visits (30d)

65,463

Content shared

97 reels · 17 posts · 71 stories

TOP CONTENT

"AGE 14 — I got kicked out of school" photo post

933K views · +14K follows

"Running your own business..." reel

822K views · 15K saves

"Comment CEO" text post

2.7K comments · +1.5K follows

Avg views per post vs per reel

~112K vs ~21K

One personal-artifact post drove 57% of the month's follower growth. A single childhood photo with an age-confession overlay out-converted 97 reels combined. Volume did not decay either: reel count doubled and views still grew 56%.

Facebook

MASS-REACH LAYER

FLAT REACH · ENGAGEMENT +112%

PERFORMANCE (JUL 1–31)

Views

3.18M · -2.1% vs June

Engagement

266,066 · +112%

Engagement rate

3.4% → 8.4%

Reactions / comments / shares

155K / 2.5K / 5K

Net follows

+14,400 (unfollows 1,430)

Total followers

85,191 · +20.9%

SHAPE OF THE MONTH

Jul 5 breakout reel

858K views

Peak day

~620K (Jul 5)

Views by type

Reel 73.8% · Multi-photo 26%

Non-follower share

96% of views

Followers on pace for

96K by Sep 30

The audience built in Q2 is engaging much deeper even with flat reach — ER more than doubled. The gap to the 4M target needs one breakout reel a month; the Jul 5 reel (858K) shows the ceiling is there. Photo posts are now a quarter of FB views — the same format shift seen on Instagram.

TikTok

ALGORITHMIC REACH

2.5x MONTH

PERFORMANCE (JUL 1–31)

Post views	787.5K · +143%
Likes	22.9K · +135%
Shares	4K · +128%
Profile views	9.3K · +113%
Net followers	+2K → 14,704 total

SHAPE OF THE MONTH

Single-day peak	~197K views (mid-July)
Traffic from For You	96.2%
US audience share	35%
August momentum (7d)	"10 AI startup opportunities" 44K

Every metric more than doubled. The startup-listicle family carries the platform, and the exit-anniversary post ran here too — the first genuinely cross-platform campaign month.

LinkedIn ICP / AUTHORITY LAYER

BEST ER OF 2026

PERFORMANCE (JUL 1–31, VERIFIED EXPORT)

Impressions	71,776 · +38%
Engagements	1,970 · +126%
Engagement rate — engagements as % of impressions	2.74% (Apr 0.79 · May 0.49 · Jun 1.68)
Members reached	24,764
Followers	11,607 · +821 net

TOP POSTS + AUDIENCE

"Watched the World Cup final live" (Jul 20)	10.7K imp
"For two months I had no idea..."	#1 engagement (193)
Founders/CEOs by job title	30% of followers

The baseline rose without a single viral hit — the month was won on consistency, and engagement quality is the best of the year. The one metric behind pace is followers (11.6K vs the 13.5K target; needs ~950/month). The plan for exactly that is in section 06.

X SAAS/AI CONVERSATION

ALL-TIME RECORD MONTH

PERFORMANCE (JUL 1–31)

Impressions	93.4K · +338%
Impressions per post (24 posts)	~3,890 · 6x June
Bookmarks	397 · +71%
Profile visits	472 · +257%
Engagements	1.7K · +81%

TOP POSTS

Jul 22 media post	28K imp
"At 21: terrified of public speaking..."	23K imp
"At 14 I was smoking an e-cigarette at school..."	9.6K imp
"Me at 21: ran an eBay business..."	6.8K imp
Non-follower share of impressions	~90%

05 **What July Proved — and What We Replicate** Data-based conclusions

The month's biggest finding: one format won everywhere at once.

The "At [age]:" personal-timeline confession, anchored in a real artifact, took Instagram's top spot (933K views, 14K follows from one childhood photo) and 3 of X's top 5 posts in the same month. This is now a proven, repeatable series — not a lucky post.

Replicate on Instagram

- **2–3 personal-artifact posts per month** mined from Lior's real archive: childhood, army, first office, early AutoDS days. Photo posts, not reels — that's where the follows come from.
- **Brief every reel against "would someone save this"** — the 822K reel carried 15K saves.
- Best windows per IG's own recap: Thu 9am–3pm, Fri 9am–12pm.

Why the totals can hold through September

- Reel volume doubled and views still grew 56% — the current cadence isn't saturating the algorithm.
- 88–96% of views on every big platform come from non-followers — the discovery engines are open.
- Follower churn is negligible everywhere (IG unfollows ~50–107/day against 300–800 daily follows).
- Conversion is concentrated: a handful of artifact assets do the follower work, volume does the reach work. Both levers are independent.

06 **LinkedIn: The Algorithm Changed — Here's the Plan**

The fact

LinkedIn rebuilt its feed from a social graph (who follows you) to an **interest graph** (who cares about this topic).

Pillar (90-day lock)	Role	Proof it works	Profile keywords
1 • The bootstrapped founder journey — eBay ban to \$92M exit	Follower conversion	AGE-14 post: 14K follows on IG · At-age format: 3 of X's top 5	bootstrapped, founder journey, exit, 0→1
2 • Operating a 250-person SaaS company in real time	Authority with the ICP	July's #1 engagement post · audience already 30% founders/CEOs	SaaS, B2C, scaling, leadership

Pillar (90-day lock)	Role	Proof it works	Profile keywords
3 · AI in practice for e-commerce/SaaS + AI newsjacks	Reach	May's 147K + 93K breakouts · feeds the Shopify affiliate push	AI, e-commerce automation, agents

The action list

- **One-time profile audit** — headline/About carry the pillar keywords; the graph reads the profile before it distributes a single post.
- **90-day pillar lock** — every post maps to one of the three pillars, measured weekly. What fell outside the pillars (World Cup, gym, Levi's) is exactly what diluted July.
- **Write for dwell and saves, not applause** — every post briefed against "would a founder save this".
- **3–5 substantive comments/day** on target SaaS/founder accounts — comments are now distribution, posted manually.
- **Consultant engaged: Richard van der Blom** — one of the best-known LinkedIn algorithm researchers; first conversation already held.

07 Next Moves & Decisions Needed

August–September

Area	Move	Status / decision needed
Team	Off-site with the social team for the 100K-follower milestone — IG is ~4.4K away	AWAITING LIOR'S FEEDBACK
Podcasts	Booking agency vetted and in talks. Pricing: 1 podcast/month = \$1,399 · 2/month = \$2,099	LIOR: BUDGET + CADENCE

Area	Move	Status / decision needed
Conferences	AI Dev TLV — attend/speak?	LIOR: YES/NO
Conferences	Israel Business Conference (ועידת ישראל) — explore sponsorship?	LIOR: YES/NO
Events	Organize a Shopify event in Israel	REUT PROPOSES
Awards	Tech1 Awards, Eilat, October — submit Lior as a Builder (E-Commerce Company of the Year / Scale-Up of the Year). Proposed data: Revenue 50M+ · Headcount 200+ · Customers 50K+ users · worldwide · warm 2025-vs-2024 growth indication	LIOR: LEGAL SIGN-OFF ON NUMBERS — only \$20M+ ARR is on the p
New workstream	Shopify affiliate project — launching in the coming days	STARTING
YouTube	Restart with a new vendor — the Q2 vendor didn't deliver; decision made, onboarding next	RESTART

Sources

Instagram: IG app Professional Dashboard + official Monthly Recap (Jul 1–31) · Facebook: Professional Dashboard, custom Jul 1–31 · TikTok: TikTok Studio, custom Jul 1–31 · LinkedIn: Creator Analytics AggregateAnalytics export Jul 1–31 (daily, verified) · X: Account Analytics app, Jul 1–31 · Threads: app Insights (30d) · Interest-graph analysis verified against LinkedIn Engineering blog (Mar 2026).

Raw data + full conclusions: `the-system-v5/0-output/monthly-summary-2026-07/data-collected.md` ·

Prepared by Reut with Claude · August 5, 2026